

GAP ANALYSIS

Project: Retail Order Management & Refund Process Improvement

Document: Gap Analysis

Version: 1.0

A. PURPOSE

The gap analysis identifies the differences between the current **AS-IS** process and the proposed **TO-BE** process.

The objective is to identify operational problems and define how the proposed solution addresses them.

B. CURRENT GAPS

Area	Current State	Gap
Order Tracking	Information may be maintained across different sources	No single view of order status
Shipment Tracking	Shipment information is monitored separately	Limited visibility of delays
Returns	Return information requires manual tracking	Difficult to monitor pending returns
Refunds	Refund status may require manual follow-up	Limited visibility of pending refunds
Reporting	Reports require manual consolidation	Time-consuming and error-prone
KPIs	Metrics may be calculated separately	Inconsistent reporting
Exceptions	Issues are identified manually	Delayed identification of problems
Management Visibility	Information is spread across reports	No centralized performance view

C. PROPOSED IMPROVEMENTS

Gap	Proposed Improvement
Fragmented order information	Centralized order reporting
Limited shipment visibility	Shipment status tracking
Manual return tracking	Dedicated return reporting
Limited refund visibility	Pending and completed refund tracking
Manual reporting	Automated dashboard-based reporting
Inconsistent KPIs	Standardized KPI definitions
Manual exception identification	Exception-focused reporting
Limited management visibility	Centralized management dashboard

D. PRIORITY

Gap	Priority
Order visibility	High
Refund tracking	High
Return tracking	High
KPI standardization	High
Exception reporting	Medium
Shipment visibility	Medium
Management dashboard	Medium

E. EXPECTED BUSINESS BENEFITS

The proposed improvements should result in:

- Better visibility across the order lifecycle
 - Faster identification of delayed transactions
 - Easier refund monitoring
 - More consistent KPI reporting
 - Reduced manual reporting effort
 - Better operational decision-making
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F. SUCCESS MEASURES

The solution should be considered successful when users can:

- Track an order from placement through refund.
 - Identify pending and delayed transactions.
 - Monitor return and refund performance.
 - Access standardized KPIs from one dashboard.
 - Investigate operational exceptions without manually combining multiple reports.
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G. DATA IMPACT

The future project dataset will be designed to support these requirements.

The synthetic data will contain interconnected:

Orders → Shipments → Returns → Refunds

This will allow the SQL analysis, Excel workbook, Power BI dashboard, and UAT scenarios to directly demonstrate the gaps and proposed improvements identified in this document.